

Sunday, 24 May 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Clear 30° 18°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 26° 13°	MANCHESTER Overcast 24° 13°	GLASGOW Overcast 20° 14°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Farage was issued with court judgement for £9,400 debt.

Reform UK says Farage will appeal the County Court judgment because he had not been aware of the claim.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

Celebrities paint garden gnomes for Chelsea Flower Show as ban lifts.

David Beckham and Dame Mary Berry are among the famous faces to have painted gnomes to raise funds for a school gardening campaign.

UK · NEWS
- 3

King appears as surprise guest at sold-out Shakespeare play.

The monarch sat with the audience to watch a performance of the Royal Shakespeare Company's *The Tempest*.

UK · NEWS

02 – SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

- 1 'We're coming back strong!' - Girl group Mis-Teeq confirm reunion.**
The group were known for blending R&B melodies with UK garage on hits such as Scandalous and One Night Stand.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 Sam Fender, Rosalía and Jacob Alon win Ivor Novello Awards.**
Lola Young helped to honour Elton John at Thursday's event, which celebrates the craft of songwriting.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 TV presenter Judith Chalmers dies aged 90.**
She was best known for hosting ITV's long-running travel show Wish You Were Here...?
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 Career-heavy Usyk 25lb lighter than 'dangerous' Verhoeven.**
Heavyweight Oleksandr Usyk weighs a career-heavy 16st 9lb for Saturday's title defence in Egypt. but is 25lb lighter than challenger Rico Verhoeven.
SPORT · UK
- 2 Jackson smashes meeting record to win 200m.**
Two-time 200m world champion Shericka Jackson produces a dominant display to win the 200m Diamond League event in Xiamen.
SPORT · UK
- 3 Usyk v Verhoeven world title fight predictions.**
Boxing world offer their predictions for Oleksandr Usyk's world title defence against Rico Verhoeven on Saturday.
SPORT · UK
- 4 Hull threaten legal action if they lose play-off final.**
Hull City owner Acun Ilıcali vows to take legal action over the decision to reinstate Middlesbrough in the play-offs if the Tigers lose at Wembley.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 One in three of us has had a 'sleep divorce' — sleeping in a separate bed from our partner.**
Reasons: snoring (45%), different schedules (30%), restless legs, and one bizarre 12% who say their partner 'talks to the cat in their sleep'.
- 2 Holiday firms report a 40% spike in 'shoulder season' bookings — September and October sun trips are way up on last year.**
Travellers blame school-holiday flight prices, unreliable summer weather, and 'August feels too crowded these days'. Spain, Greece and Portugal top the wish list.
- 3 Three quarters of dog owners now talk to their dog more than they talk to their partner.**
Top topics: 'what we're doing later', 'what we just saw out the window' and a surprising amount of Bake Off commentary. 12% admit they've apologised to the dog after a row with the human.
- 4 The 'silver gamer' is the fastest-growing demographic in UK gaming — over-65s spent £180 million on games last year.**
Cosy life-sim titles like Stardew Valley and Animal Crossing dominate. Console makers are reportedly designing larger UI for the market.
- 5 Britain's most-stolen supermarket item in 2026 isn't meat or cheese — it's olive oil, with theft up 220% year on year.**
Prices have nearly doubled in two years. Some shops have fitted security tags to single bottles, others have moved premium brands behind the counter — like cigarettes.
- 6 Cash is making a small comeback — ATM withdrawals are up 14% on this time last year.**
Bank analysts credit budget-conscious households using cash to stay disciplined. The 'envelope method' is back trending on TikTok.
- 7 Brits spend an average of 38 minutes a day deciding what to watch — and 12 of those are spent scrolling Netflix.**
'Watch-paralysis' has its own subreddit. Streamers are quietly experimenting with 'shuffle' buttons that just play something.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 71% of us admit to doing **THIS** in the car when we think no-one is watching. What is it?
ANSWER: SINGING AT THE TOP OF OUR LUNGS, WITH FULL DRAMATIC FACIAL EXPRESSIONS.

Q Asked 'what's the most British thing about your morning?', the number one answer wasn't a cup of tea — it was **THIS**.
ANSWER: APOLOGISING TO SOMEONE WHO WALKED INTO YOU.

TALK TOPIC

- **If you could only listen to one song for the rest of your life, what is it?**
Talk-back: pick one. No 'depends on the mood'. Just one song forever — go.

- **What's the most British thing you've ever done?**
Talk-back: bonus points for the apology, the queue and the cup of tea all in one anecdote.

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Food.** The UK's bestselling biscuit in 2025 wasn't the Custard Cream or the Hobnob — it was the humble digestive, selling over 70 million packs.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A Bristol bakery has started selling 'controversial' jam doughnuts injected with mustard instead of jam, claiming a 'small but loyal' customer base.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£100 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£100 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Cows have best friends and get stressed when separated from them.
- The word 'OK' began as a misspelling joke in a Boston newspaper in 1839 ('oll korrekt').
- Sloths can hold their breath longer than dolphins — up to 40 minutes underwater.
- If you could fold a piece of paper 42 times, it would reach the moon.
- Bees can recognise human faces.
- Saturn would float in water — if you could find a bathtub big enough.
- There's a species of jellyfish that is technically immortal — *Turritopsis dohrnii*.
- Antarctica is the only continent without reptiles or snakes.

On this day

Day 144 of the year, 221 days left in 2026. Today Aldersgate Day/Wesley Day (Methodism); Battle of Pichincha Day (Ecuador); Bermuda Day (Bermuda), celebrated on the nearest weekday if May 24 falls on the weekend.; Christian feast day: Anna Pak Agi (one of The Korean Martyrs). Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1943 — Gary Burghoff, American actor
- 1947 — Waddy Wachtel, American guitarist, singer-songwriter, and record producer
- 1945 — Priscilla Presley, American actress and businesswoman
- 1960 — Kristin Scott Thomas, English actress
- 1945 — Terry Callier, American soul, folk and jazz guitarist and singer-songwriter (died 2012)
- 1965 — John C. Reilly, American actor
- 1956 — Larry Blackmon, American singer-songwriter and producer
- 1960 — Guy Fletcher, English keyboard player, guitarist, and producer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1992 — The ethnic cleansing in Kozarac, Bosnia and Herzegovina begins when Serbian militia and police forces enter the town.
- 2022 — A mass shooting occurs at Robb Elementary School in Uvalde, Texas, United States, resulting in the deaths of 21 people, including 19 children.
- 1961 — American civil rights movement: Freedom Riders are arrested in Jackson, Mississippi, for "disturbing the peace" after disembarking from their bus.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1956 — The first Eurovision Song Contest is held in Lugano, Switzerland.
- 2000 — Israeli troops withdraw from southern Lebanon after 22 years of occupation.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1967 — Belle de Jour, directed by Luis Buñuel, is released.
- 2002 — Russia and the United States sign the Moscow Treaty.

- 1948 — Arab-Israeli War: Egypt captures the Israeli kibbutz of Yad Mordechai, but the five-day effort gives Israeli forces time to prepare enough to stop the Egyptian advance a week later.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 145 of the year, 220 days left in 2026. Today Africa Day (African Union); African Liberation Day (African Union, Rastafari); Christian feast day: Aldhelm; Christian feast day: Bede. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1999 — Brec Bassinger, American actress
- 1956 — David P. Sartor, American composer and conductor
- 1982 — Adam Boyd, English footballer
- 1952 — David Jenkins, Trinidadian-Scottish runner
- 1949 — Barry Windsor-Smith, English painter and illustrator
- 1974 — Frank Klepacki, American drummer and composer
- 1943 — Leslie Uggams, American actress and singer
- 1951 — Bob Gale, American director, producer, and screenwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1973 — In protest against the dictatorship in Greece, the captain and crew on Greek naval destroyer Velos mutiny and refuse to return to Greece, instead anchoring at Fiumicino, Italy.
- 1979 — American Airlines Flight 191: A McDonnell Douglas DC-10 crashes during takeoff at O'Hare International Airport, Chicago, killing all 271 on board and two people on the ground.
- 2002 — China Airlines Flight 611 disintegrates in mid-air and crashes into the Taiwan Strait, with the loss of all 225 people on board.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1933 — The Walt Disney Company cartoon Three Little Pigs premieres at Radio City Music Hall, featuring the hit song "Who's Afraid of the Big Bad Wolf?"
- 1895 — The Republic of Formosa is formed, with Tang Jingsong as its president.

Coming to cinemas

MAY 2026	
FRI 15	Mortal Kombat II (+ IMAX); Is God Is; Poetic License
FRI 22	The Mandalorian and Grogu (+ IMAX)
JUNE 2026	
FRI 5	Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life
JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

MAY 2026		JULY 2026	
THU 14	PGA Championship begins (Golf)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
WED 20	UEFA Europa League Final	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
SAT 23	EFL Championship Play-off Final, Wembley	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
SUN 24	Premier League final day (all 10 games, 3pm BST)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
24 MAY – 7 JUN	French Open (Tennis)	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
THU 28	Premier League Darts Finals Night	AUGUST 2026	
SAT 30	UEFA Champions League Final	W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
JUNE 2026		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
THU 4	NBA Finals begin	22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)		
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts		
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)		
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)		
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon		